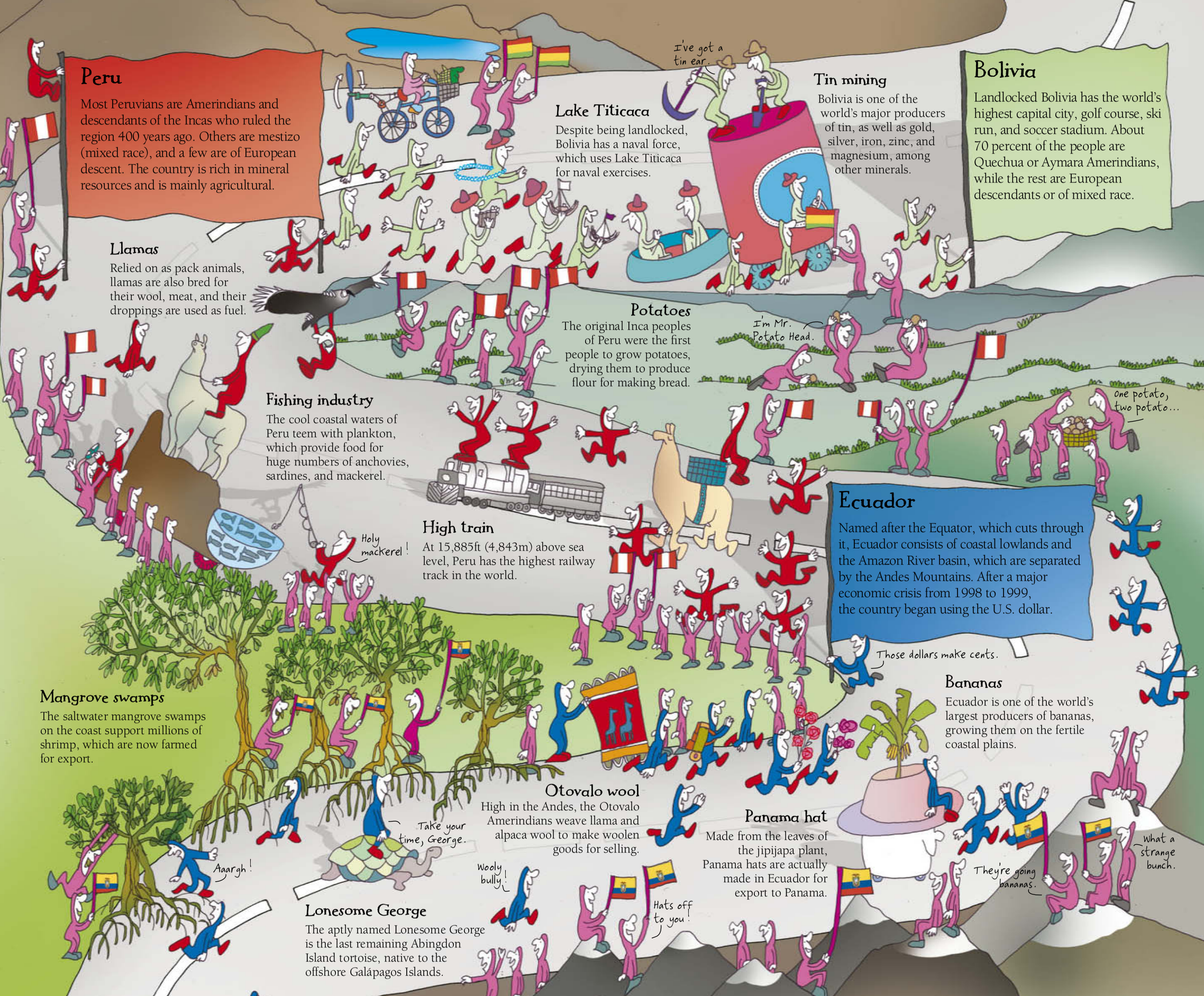
Peru
Most Peruvians are Amerindians and descendants of the Incas who ruled the region 400 years ago. Others are mestizo (mixed race), and a few are of European descent. The country is rich in mineral resources and is mainly agricultural.
Llamas
Relied on as pack animals, llamas are also bred for their wool, meat, and their droppings are used as fuel.
Lake Titicaca
Despite being landlocked, Bolivia has a naval force, which uses Lake Titicaca for naval exercises.
I've got a tin ear.
Tin mining
Bolivia is one of the world's major producers of tin, as well as gold, silver, iron, zinc, and magnesium, among other minerals.
Bolivia
Landlocked Bolivia has the world's highest capital city, golf course, ski run, and soccer stadium. About 70 percent of the people are Quechua or Aymara Amerindians, while the rest are European descendants or of mixed race.
Potatoes
The original Inca peoples of Peru were the first people to grow potatoes, drying them to produce flour for making bread.
I'm Mr. Potato Head.
One potato, two potato...
Fishing industry
The cool coastal waters of Peru teem with plankton, which provide food for huge numbers of anchovies, sardines, and mackerel.
High train
At 15,885ft (4,843m) above sea level, Peru has the highest railway track in the world.
Holy mackerel!
Ecuador
Named after the Equator, which cuts through it, Ecuador consists of coastal lowlands and the Amazon River basin, which are separated by the Andes Mountains. After a major economic crisis from 1998 to 1999, the country began using the U.S. dollar.
Those dollars make cents.
Bananas
Ecuador is one of the world's largest producers of bananas, growing them on the fertile coastal plains.
Mangrove swamps
The saltwater mangrove swamps on the coast support millions of shrimp, which are now farmed for export.
Aaargh!
Take your time, George.
Otovalo wool
High in the Andes, the Otovalo Amerindians weave llama and alpaca wool to make woolen goods for selling.
Wooly bully!
Panama hat
Made from the leaves of the jipijapa plant, Panama hats are actually made in Ecuador for export to Panama.
Hats off to you!
They're going bananas.
What a strange bunch.
Lonesome George
The aptly named Lonesome George is the last remaining Abingdon Island tortoise, native to the offshore Galápagos Islands.